

Design System & Typographic Hierarchy

AI Readiness across Skills and Competences

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1. Typography

All application text uses the system font stack (sans-serif) by default. A single exception applies: the PreviewSection sample result card on the first screen uses DM Sans, loaded via Google Fonts. No other component references a named font.

1.1 Font Families

Font	Scope	How loaded
System UI / sans-serif	Entire application	Browser default - no external dependency
DM Sans	PreviewSection card only	Google Fonts CDN - preconnect + stylesheet in index.html. Weights 400/600/700/800, optical size 9-40.
monospace	Prompt pre blocks only	Browser default monospace (Courier, Menlo, Consolas)

1.2 Typographic Scale - Base (Mobile, < 768px)

All sizes in CSS px. Font sizes are set via inline React style objects and do not respond to the browser default font size setting (known issue K04).

Class / Role	Size (px)	Weight	Line Height	Usage
t-heading	17	800	1.3	Primary page-level heading. IntroCard tagline. Used sparingly - one per screen.
t-body	14	500-700	varies	Skill names in SkillRow. Occupation titles in picker. Main body labels.

Class / Role	Size (px)	Weight	Line Height	Usage
t-label	13	600	1.5	Apply line inside skill rows. Section labels in result tabs.
t-sub	12	400-600	1.6-1.85	AI summary observation and nextstep text in ComparisonPanel.
t-meta	11	400	1.65	Prompt pre block text. Monospace font.
result-text-sm	12	400	varies	Skill names inside ComparisonPanel rows. Scales up at 1024px+.
Section label (uppercase)	10-11	700	1.5	All-caps labels: AI Tool, Approach, Skills to develop. letterSpacing 0.05-0.06em.
Micro / badge	9-10	600-700	1	Readiness badges (Copy and go, Quick prep, Prep needed). Technique badges. ESCO ID links.
Muted hint	10-11	400	1.5	Helper text under inputs. Italic footnotes. In-tab guidance.
Search input	15	400	normal	Main search box. Picker re-search input. Largest interactive text.
Tab pill	13	700	normal	Navigation tab labels. Active tab uses accent colour.
PreviewSection heading	15	800	1.25	Sample Result card heading. DM Sans. letterSpacing -0.01em.
Site title / header	14	varies	normal	Top-bar product name. white-space: nowrap at 480px+.

1.3 Responsive Font Scaling

Seven breakpoints govern font size. The t-* CSS classes are overridden via !important at each breakpoint. Inline styles remain fixed (they do not respond to media queries without !important).

Class	< 768px	768px	1024px	1280px	2000px	2560px
t-heading	17	18	20	21	24	28
t-body	14	15	16	16	18	20
t-label	13	13	14	14	15	17
t-sub	12	13	14	14	16	17
t-meta	11	12	13	13	14	15
result-text-sm	12	12	13	13	15	16

Class	< 768px	768px	1024px	1280px	2000px	2560px
body (html)	14 (default)	15	16	16	18	20

Additionally: `html { zoom: 1.1 }` applies at 1153px+ (set in `index.html <style>` block). This scales the entire page layout, not just text. Tab labels receive an extra font-size lift at 1200-1500px via `.tab-label { font-size: 13px !important }`.

1.4 Font Weights in Use

Weight	Usage contexts
800 (Extra Bold)	Page-level headings (t-heading). PreviewSection card heading (DM Sans). Comparison panel section titles (Transferable strengths, Comparing these roles).
700 (Bold)	Card headings. Section headings inside panels. Tab pills (active and inactive). All-caps uppercase labels. Badge text. Skill names in progression cards. Navigation labels.
600 (Semi-Bold)	Skill names in SkillRow header. Apply line. Stage feed status text. Card sub-headings. Inline bold within body copy.
500 (Medium)	Skill name in expanded SkillRow body. Occupation card titles in default state.
400 (Regular)	All body copy. ESCO descriptions. Approach text. Hint text. Muted labels. Explanation card body.

1.5 Letter Spacing

Value	Usage
0.06em	Prompt label (uppercase PROMPT). Section sub-labels in ComparisonPanel rows.
0.05em	Stage feed uppercase labels (Career paths, Crossover roles, Expanding skill details).
0.04em	LivePromptCard building prompt status label.
0.03em	Who is this most useful for? label in IntroCard.
0.02em	Tagline italic text.
-0.01em	PreviewSection Sample Result heading (tighter for large weight headings).

2. Colour System

All colours are defined in the C constant at the top of App.jsx. Semantic colour tokens are used throughout - never raw hex values except where a colour is unique to one component and is documented below.

2.1 Core Palette - C Tokens

	Token	Hex	Usage
	C.bg #f5f7fa Page background. Screen-level surface.		
	C.surface #ffffff Card and panel surface. Elevated containers.		
	C.border #dde3ec Default border on cards, inputs, dividers.		
	C.accent #1a56db Primary brand colour. Active tab underline. Active buttons. Links. Nav accent border.		
	C.accentSoft #e8f0fe Light accent background for selected states and info banners.		
	C.eu #003399 ESCO / EU attribution elements. Search button.		
	C.euStar #ffcc00 EU star accent colour (ESCO branding).		
	C.muted #6b7a8d Secondary body text. Helper text. Inactive labels.		
	C.mutedLight #9aa5b4 Tertiary labels. Collapse arrows. Number badges.		
	C.text #1a202c Primary text. Headings. Strong labels.		
	C.textSub #4a5568 Secondary body text. Approach descriptions. Notes.		
	C.green #166534 Human-Led label text. Success states. Comparison shared skills.		
	C.greenBg #ecfdf5 Human-Led background. Success banner background.		
	C.greenBdr #a7f3d0 Human-Led border. Success banner border.		
	C.purple #7c3aed Prep needed badge text. Industry Crossover persona.		

	Token	Hex	Usage
	C.purpleBg #f3e8ff Prep needed badge background. Crossover persona background.		
	C.purpleBdr #ddd6fe Prep needed badge border. Crossover persona border.		
	C.teal #0e7490 Feedback link. ComparisonPanel AI reflection heading.		
	C.tealBg #ecfeff Feedback link background. Comparison reflection background.		
	C.tealBdr #a5f3fc Feedback link border. Comparison reflection border.		
	C.amber #b45309 Warning / notice text. May not apply pill text.		
	C.amberBg #ffffeb Warning banner background. Prep card background.		
	C.amberBdr #fcd9a0 Warning banner border. Prep card border.		

2.2 Automation Level Colours - LEVELS Tokens

Used across SkillRow badges, ExposureBar, ComparisonPanel bars, and live activity feed chips. Defined in the LEVELS constant.

	Level	Text colour	Background	Border
	Full Automation (HIGH) Text #dc2626 Bg #fef2f2 Border #fecaca			
	AI-Augmented (MEDIUM) Text #d97706 Bg #ffffeb Border #fcd9a0			
	AI-Assisted (LOW) Text #2563eb Bg #eff6ff Border #bfbdbf			
	Human-Led (HUMAN) Text #166534 Bg #f0fdf4 Border #a7f3d0			

2.3 Semantic Colour Usage by UI Zone

UI Zone	Colour application
Page background	C.bg (#f5f7fa) - light grey. Never pure white at page level.
Card / panel surface	C.surface (ffffff) - white. All cards, modals, expanded rows.

UI Zone	Colour application
Primary action	C.accent (#1a56db) - Analyse button fill, active tab underline, navigation border.
Search / ESCO button	C.eu (#003399) - EU blue reserved for ESCO-related actions only.
Info banners	C.accentSoft bg + #c3d3f5 border - function keyword notice, picker heading.
Warning banners	C.amberBg + C.amberBdr - noExactMatch notice, may not apply pill, skill count variance.
Success / Human	C.greenBg + C.greenBdr - Human-Led level, shared skill chips, comparison overlap.
Error states	#fdecea bg + #f5c6c2 border - not found, invalid input. #c0392b text.
Prompt block	#f0f9ff bg + #bae6fd border (light blue). Prompt pre: #e0f2fe bg, #0c4a6e text.
What to do Next card	White surface, C.border. Heading colour varies by automation level (purple HIGH, green LOW/MEDIUM).
AI Reflection card	C.tealBg + C.tealBdr - warm teal for humble, non-prescriptive AI output.
PreviewSection wrapper	#ffffff surface, borderRadius 16, box-shadow 0 4px 24px rgba(0,0,0,0.09).

2.4 Additional Spot Colours

Colours used in specific components that fall outside the C token set.

	Hex	Usage
	#0369a1 Prompt block heading label. Prompt pre text. Prompt copy button text.	
	#1e40af What to do Next heading. Career path pills in feed. Progression card direction.	
	#1e3a8a What to do Next step body text.	
	#0c4a6e Prompt pre code text. AI summary body text.	
	#f97316 LivePromptCard building dot colour (orange). In-progress state only.	
	#86198f What to do Next heading for Full Automation skills.	
	#0e7490 Comparison view-as-role button. Teal highlight for active role.	
	#dc2626 Error headings. Confirm-delete button. Full Automation level.	

	Hex	Usage
	#dcfce7 Copy and go badge background (green).	

3. Device Layouts & Breakpoints

The application is mobile-first. Layout is controlled via CSS custom properties and media queries in the global style block inside App.jsx, plus a viewport meta tag in index.html.

3.1 Viewport Configuration

Setting	Value / Note
viewport meta	width=device-width, initial-scale=1.0, interactive-widget=resizes-content
interactive-widget	resizes-content - on-screen keyboard shrinks the viewport rather than overlapping content. Prevents input obscured by keyboard on iOS / Android.
App height	--app-height: 100svh. svh (small viewport height) handles keyboard resize natively. Falls back to 100vh where svh unsupported.
html zoom	zoom: 1.1 at min-width 1153px (index.html). Scales the entire rendered page. Not applied on mobile or tablet.

3.2 Breakpoint System

Breakpoint	CSS px	Changes
Mobile (default)	0 - 599px	--content-pad: 12px. Single column. All panels stacked. isNarrow mode in ComparisonPanel. Search input full width.
Mobile+	480px - 599px	site-title white-space: normal, font-size: 13px at max-width 479px. Normalises at 480px+.
Tablet	600px+	--content-pad: 20px. main-content padding adjusts. body font-size 15px. t-* classes first scale up.
Tablet landscape / small laptop	768px+	site-title font-size: 16px. body 15px. t-heading 18px, t-body 15px, t-sub 13px.
Laptop	900px+	--content-pad: 32px. --content-max: 900px.
Desktop	1024px+	body 16px. t-heading 20px. t-body 16px. result-text-sm 13px. html zoom: 1.1 activates at 1153px.

Breakpoint	CSS px	Changes
Large desktop	1200px+	--content-max: 1000px. tab-label font-size: 13px at 1200-1500px.
Wide desktop	1280px+	t-heading 21px.
Ultra wide	1600px+	--content-max: 1080px.
2K	2000px+	--content-max: 1200px. body 18px. html font-size 18px. t-heading 24px.
4K	2560px+	--content-max: 1320px. body 20px. html font-size 20px. t-heading 28px.

3.3 Content Width Constraints

Variable	Value
--content-max (default)	820px - mobile and narrow tablet
--content-max (900px+)	900px
--content-max (1200px+)	1000px
--content-max (1600px+)	1080px
--content-max (2000px+)	1200px
--content-max (2560px+)	1320px
.main-content	max-width: var(--content-max); margin: 0 auto; padding: var(--content-pad) 16px

3.4 Orientation

No explicit landscape/portrait media queries are used. The responsive breakpoint system handles both orientations by CSS width. On mobile in landscape, the narrower viewport height means the spinner and loading feed may require scrolling.

ComparisonPanel uses a ResizeObserver (not a media query) to detect narrow rendering. isNarrow = true when panel content width < 560px. This is layout-driven, not screen-driven, so it responds correctly when the panel is inside a constrained container at any viewport size.

3.5 Component-Level Responsive Patterns

Pattern	Used in
flex-wrap: wrap	Skill badge rows, action button rows, comparison sub-labels. Wraps gracefully on narrow screens without breakpoints.

Pattern	Used in
display: grid, auto-fit / auto-fill	PersonaToggle (minmax(200px, 1fr)). Adapts from 1 to 2 columns based on available space.
isNarrow ResizeObserver	ComparisonPanel: switches from multi-column grid to stacked role selector at < 560px container width.
flex: 1 1 auto (flex grow/shrink)	AI Tool and Approach mini-cards inside SkillRow body. Reflow from side-by-side to stacked automatically.
overflowX: auto	Tab bar scrolls horizontally on mobile. Comparison automation bar chip row. Stage feed career path pills.
maxWidth: 480px on modal	SkillExpertOverlay modal. Centres and constrains on wide screens.
whiteSpace: nowrap + flexShrink: 0	Level badge tags. Ensures badges never wrap mid-label.

4. Spacing & Shape

4.1 Border Radius Scale

Radius	Usage
50% (circle)	Spinner dot. Stage tick dots. Skill number badge. Progress dots. Avatar-style indicators.
20px (pill)	Level badges (Tag component). Tab pills. Feedback link. Comparison role chips.
16px	PreviewSection outer card wrapper only.
12px	SkillExpertOverlay modal. Toast notification. CompareWarningModal.
10px	Main info cards (IntroCard, Spinner explanation cards, CommunityNote body). Standard card container.
8px	OccCard picker items. DeviceNote. Notices (noExactMatch, functionKeyword). ErrBox.
7px	SkillRow border (2px solid). Prompt block container. Search input. Re-search input in picker.
6px	AI Tool / Approach micro-cards. Skill detail sub-cards. Stage feed skill rows.
5px	Prompt pre block. Stage feed skill row items.
4px	Readiness badges (Copy and go, Quick prep, Prep needed). Flat label style.

4.2 Key Spacing Values

Value	Usage
--content-pad (12-32px)	Outer horizontal page padding. Scales with viewport.
16px horizontal padding	main-content default inner padding alongside content-pad.
14px / 16px card padding	Standard card internal padding (14px 16px or 12px 16px).
9px / 13px skill row padding	SkillRow header: 9px 13px. Body: 2px 13px 11px 41px (41px left indent aligns with text past number badge).
10px gap	Standard grid gap in ComparisonPanel and card grids.
8px gap	Standard flex gap between badge elements and skill row items.
6px gap	Tight pill row gaps. Inline badge row gaps.

5. Iconography & Visual Indicators

No icon library is used. All icons are Unicode characters or CSS-drawn elements.

5.1 Automation Level Icons

Level	Icon	Rationale
Full Automation (HIGH)	⚡ (lightning)	Immediate, high-energy, machine-speed. Signals replacement risk.
AI-Augmented (MEDIUM)	~ (tilde)	Approximation. AI does most, human modulates. Deliberately understated.
AI-Assisted (LOW)	● (filled circle)	Present but bounded. AI as a tool, human in control.
Human-Led (HUMAN)	◆ (diamond)	Faceted, multi-dimensional. Human judgement cannot be flattened.

5.2 Directional & Status Icons

Icon	Usage
↑ (upward)	Career progression dir: up. Step Up badge.
↔ / →	Lateral move direction.
🏠 / ★	Specialist direction in ProgressionCard.

Icon	Usage
□ (ladder)	Step suggestion in ProgressionCard - bridge role between current and target.
✓ (tick)	Stage complete in loading feed. Queued comparison role. Skill already queued.
⌚ (hourglass)	Pending role in comparison queue.
✕ / ×	Close modal. Remove from comparison.
▲ / ▼	Expand / collapse chevrons on all collapsible panels and cards.
🔍 (magnifier)	Who uses this skill? button inside SkillRow.
✉ (envelope)	Feedback email link.
⚖ (scales)	Compare tab and comparison queue label.

5.3 Animated Indicators

Indicator	Implementation
Spinner ring	36x36px div. 3px border, accent borderTop. @keyframes sp: rotate 360deg, 0.7s linear infinite.
Stage mini-spinner	10x10px span. 2px border. sp animation. Used for in-progress stages in loading feed.
LivePromptCard cursor	2px wide inline-block span. sp animation with step-end timing (hard blink). Disappears on done.
Skill blink (firstBlinkSkill)	@keyframes skillBlink: box-shadow pulse 0.9s ease-in-out infinite. 20-second duration, then cleared.
Pulse dots	@keyframes pulse: opacity + translateX. Used for trailing load indicator and waiting dots in loading feed.
Progress dots	8px circles. Background transitions from C.border to C.accent as subStep increments.
fadeInUp	@keyframes fadeInUp: opacity 0 to 1, translateY 10px to 0. Applied to stage entries, skill rows, prompt card.
fadeInRow	@keyframes fadeInRow: opacity 0 to 1, translateY 6px to 0. Skill rows in loading feed.
Jump highlight	3px left border accent applied to skill row for 3 seconds after jumpToSkill navigation.

6. Component Visual Patterns

6.1 Card Hierarchy

Card type	Border treatment	Background
PreviewSection outer wrapper	No border. Box-shadow only.	#ffffff. Shadow: 0 4px 24px rgba(0,0,0,0.09), 0 1px 4px rgba(0,0,0,0.06).
Standard info card	1px solid C.border. borderRadius 10.	C.surface (#ffffff).
SkillRow (closed)	2px solid C.border. borderRadius 7.	C.surface.
SkillRow (open)	2px solid level.border.	level.bg (colour by automation level).
ProgressionCard (open)	1px solid direction.border.	direction.bg.
Prompt block	1px solid #bae6fd.	#f0f9ff.
What to do Next card	1px solid C.border.	#ffffff (white surface inside prompt block).
Navigation accent	2px solid C.accent top border.	Transparent.
OccCard hover	1px solid #c3d3f5.	C.accentSoft (#e8f0fe).
Modal overlay	rgba(0,0,0,0.45) backdrop.	C.bg for modal panel. borderRadius 12.

6.2 Badge Variants

Badge	Background	Text colour	Border radius
Level tag (pill)	level.bg	level.color	20px (full pill)
Copy and go	#dcfce7	#166534	4px (flat label)
Quick prep first	#fffbeb	#b45309	4px (flat label)
Prep needed	#f3e8ff	#7c3aed	4px (flat label)
Technique badge	technique.bg	technique.color	10px (soft pill)
ESCO UUID link	#eff6ff	#2563eb	4px. monospace font.
May not apply	#fffbeb	#b45309	4px. Amber warning.
Contextualised	#f3f4f6	#6b7280	4px. Grey neutral.
Shared skill chip	#dcfce7	#166534	12px.
Career path pill	#eff6ff	#1e40af	12px.
Crossover role pill	C.greenBg	C.green	12px.

7. Images & External Assets

7.1 Images

The application contains no photographic or illustrative images. No `<img>` tags. No background-image CSS. All visual elements are CSS-drawn or Unicode characters.

The LinkedIn SVG icon in CommunityNote is the only inline SVG in the application. It is 12x12px, path-only, fill #0a66c2.

7.2 External Resources

Resource	Detail
DM Sans (Google Fonts)	fonts.googleapis.com + fonts.gstatic.com. Preconnect links in index.html. Weights 400/600/700/800. display=swap. Loaded for PreviewSection only.
Vercel Speed Insights	Loaded via main.jsx. No visible UI impact.
ESCO REST API	api/esco.js proxy. Taxonomy source for skill names and descriptions. No images returned.

8. Accessibility Notes

Item	Implementation
Skip nav link	Visually hidden <code></code> in index.html. Becomes visible on keyboard focus.
Language	lang=en-GB on <code><html></code> . Cambridge-Oxford English grammar throughout.
Semantic HTML	Main content wrapped in <code><main id=main-content></code> . Headings use <code><h1></code> - <code><h3></code> where appropriate.
Hover states	All interactive cards have <code>onMouseEnter</code> / <code>onMouseLeave</code> handlers. Rule: if one card of a type has hover, all cards of that type must have hover.
Touch targets	Minimum 36px height on interactive elements. Dual close buttons on SkillExpertOverlay modal for mobile.
Colour contrast	Text colours against their backgrounds are selected for legibility but have not been formally audited against WCAG AA.
Font size floor	Minimum inline font-size is 9px (badges). Known issue: inline px sizes cannot be overridden by browser font size settings (K04).

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Sometimes the scenic route is the right one.*